PARANOIA

Treatment Document

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Elevator Pitch

After taking an experimental hallucinogen, *Goop 53*, on their night off, a college Resident Advisor (RA) is unexpectedly called to fill in to complete the nightly rounds. As the drug takes effect, the dorm building becomes surreal and ever-changing, where the line between reality and hallucination becomes indistinguishable. To make it through the night, the RA must navigate distorted hallways, solve mind-bending puzzles, and address bizarre student problems.

Detailed Description

- When does the game take place?
    - Modern day, possibly during a school break where there are some but not many students remaining in the dorm
- Where does the game take place?
    - College Dorm Building (Camelot Hall), multiple floors and outside.
- Who/what are the protagonist and adversary (which one is the player)?
    - The protagonist is a college student RA
    - There is no adversary as a person, but the trip counts as the adversary

        - Hallucinations (though may not actually have malintent and may or may not interact with the protagonist)
        - Students that can notice if you are acting oddly
- Explain the primary objective of the player and how the player wins.
    - The objective is to make it through rounds as your trip gets progressively more and more trippy, while also trying to not call attention to the fact you are high.
- Explain the general game narrative (if any) in 1‑2 paragraphs
    - It's Twizz's night off at the Institute of Psychedelics Worcester (IPW) during fall break. With no responsibilities in sight, they decide to try *Goop-53*, an experimental hallucinogen given to them by a friend. Unfortunately, their plans take an unexpected turn when their boss calls and orders them to cover the nightly RA round at Camelot Hall.

      What should be a routine walk through the dorm quickly spirals into chaos as *Goop-53* takes effect. The hallways twist, familiar objects become unfamiliar, and the remaining students in the dorm seem increasingly strange. With their job on the line, Twizz must complete their responsibilities by navigating a building that is no longer recognizable to them, and somehow convince everyone that everything is perfectly fine.
- What is the basic game mechanic? (Use visuals, as appropriate)
    - Puzzles based around alternative perception and hallucinations
        - Putting something back together with delayed mouse controls
        - Simon says type puzzle with a keypad with partial reliance on audio (audio hallucinations may show up later)
    - Puzzles also around interacting with others without calling attention to the fact that you are high
    - (Potentially) Paranoia system: Track the player's paranoia level based on suspicious behavior. Paranoia gradually decreases over time. Paranoia increases faster when other students are within the vicinity, and decreases faster when nobody is around. Higher paranoia can increase the intensity/creepiness of visuals and audio.
        - Triggers that increase paranoia:
            - Looking around excessively
            - Colliding with real objects
            - NPC proximity
            - Being watched
            - Sprinting or jumping repeatedly
            - Witnessing hallucinations
            - Getting lost or going in loops
            - Failing puzzles

        - Interactions with NPCs that are clearly suspicious
    - Triggers that decrease paranoia:
        - Standing still – calms down Twizz
        - Returning to familiar areas(?)
        - Completing RA responsibilities

Asset List

- **Twizz Player Model** Human college student
- **NPC Student Models**
- **Hallucination Creatures**
- **Goop 53**
- **Mirror**
- **Doors**
- **Level Design**
    - **More rooms** How many rooms will there end up being?
    - **Dorm Room** with interior assets as the starting room
    - **Hall**
    - **Outside**
    - **Mirrors**
    - **Stairway**
- **Basic Movement**
- **Puzzles**
- **Audio effects**
- **Psychedelic Visual**
- **Physics (weird)**
    - **Object Impermanence**
- **UI**

Technical Requirements

What	Description	Implementation
Psychedelic visual effects	Distort the environment using shifting colors, warped geometry, and other psychedelic effects	Post-processing and shaders and such
Puzzle system	Create puzzles involving hallucinations	Blueprints, collision detection, event triggers

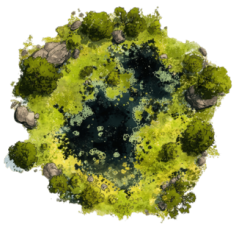
Level design & environment changes	Dorm floors with varying effects from the hallucinations	UE level editor, BP actors, level streaming
Trippy physics & movements	Implement altered physics such as floating objects, changing gravity, object distortion, walking, etc	BP physics stuff, character movement components
Object impermanence	Objects can appear, disappear, change, etc. depending on the player's state	BP visibility and collision toggling
NPC interaction	Allow the player to interact w students to complete requests (and potentially avoid paranoia by behaving normally)	BPs, AI controllers, behavior trees
Audio Effects	Immersive and unsettling audio. Distorted sounds and hallucination-triggered audio affects	Uhhhh idk

References

Pinterest Board: https://pin.it/2qWhQD5LS

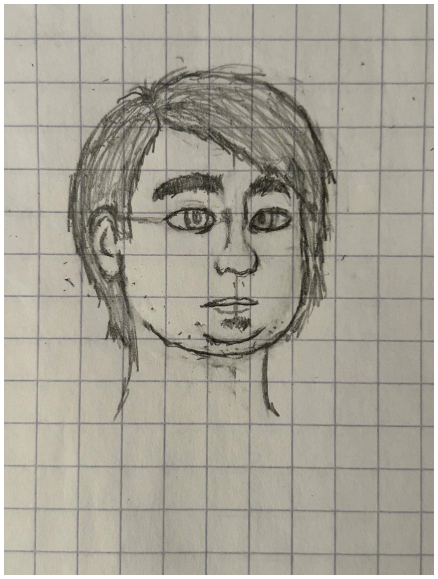
Goop 53



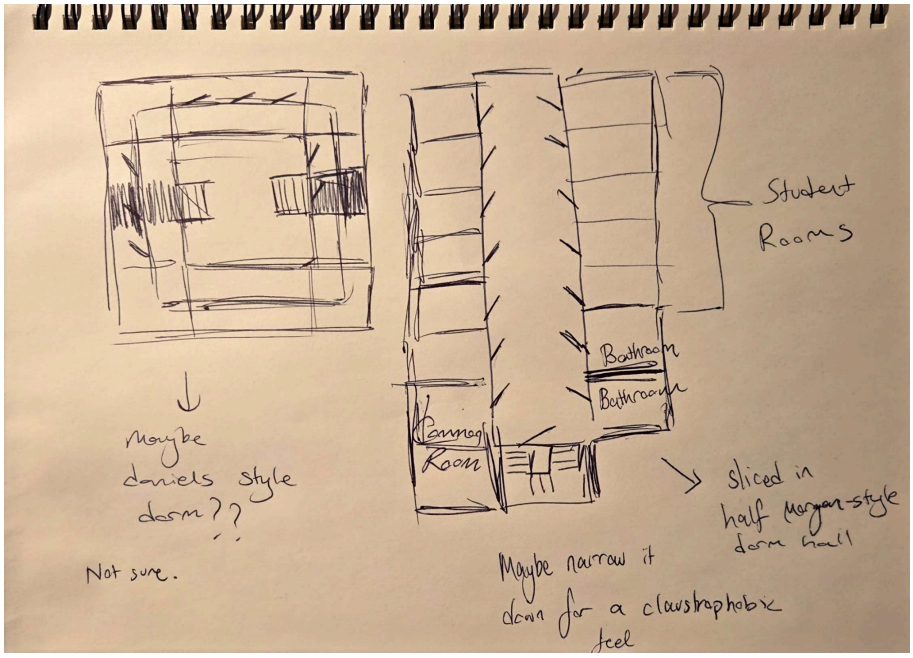



Concept Art

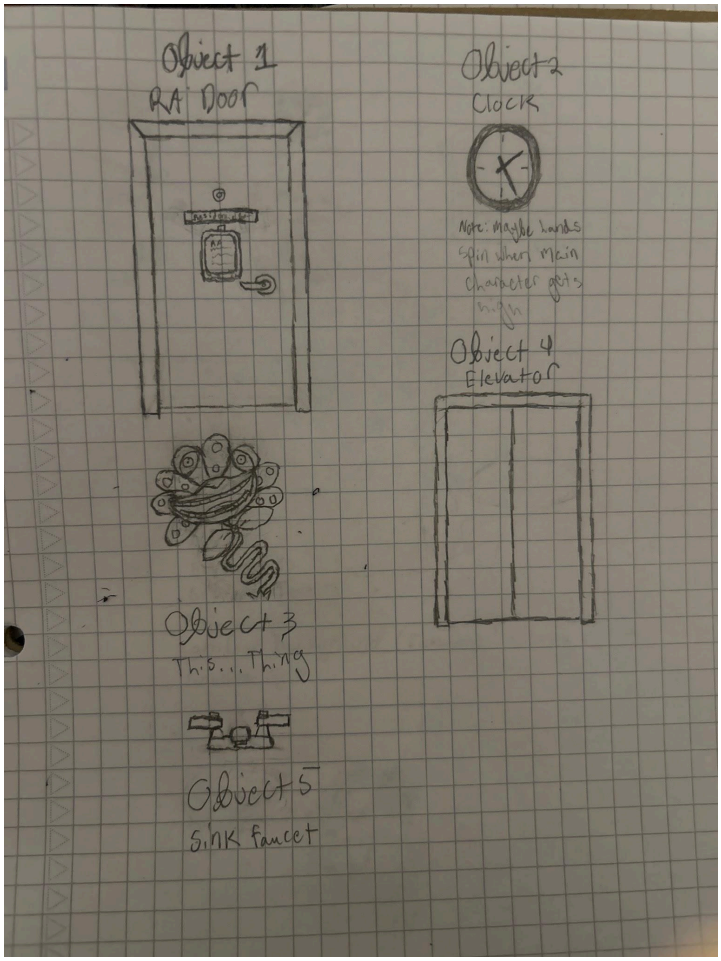
Twizz



Environment



Objects


Object 1
RA Door
Object 2
Clock
Note: Maybe hands spin when Main character gets high
Object 4
Elevator
Object 3
This... Thing
Object 5
Sink Faucet